Courtney A. Smith, M.S.

Email: Courtneysmith@mednet.ucla.edu

EDUCATION

2021 – 2026
Medical Student | UCLA David Geffen School of Medicine
David Geffen Medical Scholarship recipient

2017 – 2018
Graduate Student | The Scripps Research Institute

2014 – 2017
M.S. in Chemistry | University of South Florida

2010 – 2014
B.A. with Honors in Chemistry | University of South Florida

2009 – 2010
Undergraduate Student | Williams College

LEADERSHIP

2019 – present:
Founder of Glimmering Bridges
Grassroots Volunteer Organization

2020 – 2022
Orange County Commissioner District 3
Behavioral Health Advisory Board

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: SQL, JavaScript, R, Python, SAS, Stata

Database: REDCap (DB Design, API Scripting)

Tools: VS Code, Git, SSMS (VA VINCI), RStudio, Pandas, NumPy, Regex, Scikit-learn, spaCy, Hugging Face Transformers

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Publications

- **Smith CA**, Gunasti J, Kaabi O, Murdock A, Manatunga AK, Lash TL, Silverberg MJ, Getahun D, Vupputuri S, McCracken CE, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Incidence of Hidradenitis Suppurativa in Transgender and Cisgender Individuals: A Multicenter Matched Cohort Study. *Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology*. Published online February 12, 2026:S0190-9622(26)00220-3. PMID: 41690488
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Manatunga AK, Lash TL, Silverberg MJ, Getahun D, Vupputuri S, McCracken CE, Chen SC, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Acne Incidence and Severity in Transgender Individuals. *JAMA Dermatology*. Published online January 21, 2026:e255597. PMID: 41563779
- **Smith CA**, Cheng A, Yeung H. Smoking cessation and persistence in skin cancer survivors: a cross-sectional study of National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey, 2009-2018. *Dermatology*. Published online February 19, 2026:1-11. PMID: 41712478
- **Smith CA**, Ohamadike C, Deitelzweig C, Nock MR, Cohen JM, Yeung H. Healthcare barriers among sexual and gender minority skin cancer survivors: A cross-sectional analysis. [Submitted, under review].
- **Smith CA**, Das R, Yeung H. Permanent hair removal in gender diverse adults assigned male at birth: a cross-sectional study. *Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology*. 2025;93(5):1291-1294. PMID: 40615093
- **Smith CA**, Pulminskas A, Rogers J, Fischer A, Deitelzweig C, Ohamadike C, Lawley L, Yeung H. Managing common dermatologic needs in transgender and gender-diverse adolescents. *Current Pediatrics Reports*. 2024;13:8. PMID: 40547400
- **Smith CA**, Machado KTL, Cheng A, Tribble JT, Scout, Yeung H. Skin cancer treatment environment and survivorship resources among sexual and gender minority patients: results of the OUT National Cancer Survey. *Archives of Dermatological Research*. 2025;317(1):253. PMID: 39820662
- **Smith CA**, Gosnell E, Karatas TB, Deitelzweig C, Collins, EMB, Yeung, H. Hormonal Therapies for Acne: A Comprehensive Update for Dermatologists. *Dermatology and Therapy*. 2025;15(1):45-59. PMID: 39751745

- **Smith CA**, Ganz T, Nemeth E, Kuklinski L. Association between serum iron status and skin cancer odds: A cross-sectional study of adults in the United States. *Clinical, Cosmetic and Investigational Dermatology*. Accepted, January 2025.
- **Smith CA**, Pithadia D, Wang D, Hogeling M, Cheng CE. Video synchronous isotretinoin management is associated with lower risk of patient attrition compared to in-person follow-up: A single-center cohort study involving propensity-score matched analysis of patients with acne. *JAAD International*. 2025;18:35-37. PMID: 39618913
- **Smith CA**, Hogeling M, Cheng C. Treatment of acne-induced macular hyperpigmentation in Fitzpatrick skin types V-VI: a scoping review. *Journal of Drugs in Dermatology*. 2025;24(6):579-584. PMID: 40465499
- Holt AC, **Smith CA**, Berkowitz MJ, Baker JL, McAndrew NP, Kapoor NS. Surgical outcomes following neoadjuvant chemotherapy with and without immunotherapy in patients with triple-negative breast cancer. *Discover Oncology*. 2024;15:467. PMID: 39302495
- **Smith CA**, Kuklinski LF. Skin cancer diagnosis associated with asthma and hay fever: a nationwide cross-sectional study. *Archives of Dermatological Research*. 2024;316(9):620. PMID: 39276233
- Huy T, Graham DS, Baker JL, Thompson CK, **Smith C**, Holt AC, Kapoor NS. Safety and Margin Positivity Rates of Surgeon-Performed Intraoperative Ultrasound-Guided Wire Localization for Breast Cancer. *Surgical Oncology Insight*. 2024;1(2): 100057. doi: 10.1016/j.soi.2024.100057
- Chen T-G, Zhang H, Mykhailiuk PK, Merchant RR, **Smith CA**, Qin T, Baran PS. Quaternary Centers by Nickel-Catalyzed Cross-Coupling of Tertiary Carboxylic Acids and (Hetero)Aryl Zinc Reagents. *Angew. Chem. Int Ed Engl.* 2019;58(8):2454-2458. PMID: 30623547
- **Smith CA**, Motika S, Wojtas L, Shi X. Accessing alternative reaction pathways of the intermolecular condensation between homo-propargyl alcohols and terminal alkynes through divergent gold catalysis. *Chem. Comm.* 2016;53(15):2315-2318. PMID: 28074975 [Cover article]
- Hosseyni S, **Smith CA**, Wojtas L, Shi X. Gold-Catalyzed Vinyl Ether Hydroalkynylation: An Alternative Pathway for the Gold-Catalyzed Intermolecular Reaction of Alkenes and Alkynes. *Org. Lett.* 2016;18(24):6336-6339. PMID: 27978688
- Martin MD, Calcul L, **Smith C**, Jinwal UK, Fontaine SN, Darling A, Seeley K, Wojtas L, Narayan M, Gestwicki JE, Smith GR, Reitz AB, Baker BJ, Dickey CA. Synthesis, Stereochemical Analysis, and Derivatization of Myricanol Provide New Probes That Promote Autophagic Tau Clearance. *ACS Chem. Biol.* 2015;10(4):1099-1109. PMID: 25588114

Published Abstracts Presented at Conferences

- **Smith CA**, Yeung H, Cheng C, Hogeling M. Adherence to oral antibiotic duration guidelines for acne treatment in transgender adolescents: a retrospective cohort study. *JID.* 2026;146(3):S23.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Murdock A, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Hidradenitis Suppurativa Prevalence in Transgender and Cisgender Youth: A Multi-Regional Cross-Sectional Study. *JID.* 2026;146(3):S3.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Chen SC, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. 0726 Acne incidence and severity in transgender adults: A multi-center cohort study. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S126.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. 0685 Acne incidence in transgender adolescents: A multi-center cohort study. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S119.
- Braun H, **Smith CA**, Demissie MT, Issa AM, Kidane TY, Stoff B, Yeung H. LB1081 Curriculum on research self-efficacy, motivations, and barriers for dermatology residents in Ethiopia. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S188.
- Cheng AH, **Smith CA**, Yeung H. LB1203 Smoking prevalence and cessation in skin cancer survivors: A cross-sectional survey. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S120.
- Pulminskas A, **Smith CA**, Joshi K, Rogers J, Deitelzweig C, Gosnell E, Kitchens E, Abu-Ghosh F, Machado K, Yeung H. 0721 Remote, participant-acquired images for acne research in transgender and gender-diverse individuals: A prospective cohort study. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S125.

- Das R, **Smith CA**, Yeung, H. 0687 Permanent hair removal and psychosocial outcomes in transgender and gender-diverse adults assigned male at birth: A cross-sectional study. *JID*. 2025;145(8):S119.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. 8 Acne prevalence and severity in transgender adolescents: A multi-center, validated cohort study. *JID*. 2025;145(3):E3.
- **Smith CA**, Pithadia D, Wang D, Hogeling M, Cheng CE. Isotretinoin dosing and patient demographics predict elevation of triglyceride abnormalities during acne treatment. *JID*. 2024;144(8):S54.
- **Smith CA**, Wang D, Pithadia D, Hogeling M, Cheng CE. 52472 Deconstructing trends in the equity of teledermatology use and outcomes among acne patients on isotretinoin during the COVID-19 pandemic: a single-center retrospective analysis. *Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology*. 2024;91(3):AB173.
- Holt AC, Berkowitz M, McAndrew N, **Smith C**, Baker J, Kapoor N. Abstract PO2-22-10: Surgical outcomes after neoadjuvant chemotherapy with and without immunotherapy in patients with triple negative breast cancer. *Cancer Research.* 2024;84(9_Supplement): PO2-22-10.

PEER-REVIEW SERVICE

- *Archives of Dermatological Research*, Ad-hoc reviewer (Aug 2025 – present)
- *JAMA Dermatology*, Ad-hoc reviewer (Sep 2025 – present)

PRESENTATIONS

- **Smith CA**, Villanueva A, Galamgam J, Cheng C, Hogeling M. Isotretinoin for acne in transgender and gender-diverse adolescents. SID Annual Meeting; May 14-19, 2026; Chicago, IL. [Poster accepted]
- Gunasti J, Joshi K, Pulminskas A, Rogers J, Deitelzweig C, Ohamadike C, **Smith CA**, Abu-Ghosh F, Kitchens E, Yeung H. Acne severity and quality of life in transgender patients on gender-affirming hormone therapy: a pilot longitudinal cohort. SID Annual Meeting; May 14-19, 2026; Chicago, IL. [Poster accepted]
- **Smith CA**, Murdock A, Cheng A, Gunasti J, Bhatt S, Peykova T, Li Y, Yeung H. Oral doxycycline dosing and treatment pathways in acne: A multi-center cohort study, 2010-2022. Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Dermatology; March 27-31, 2026; Denver, CO. [ePoster accepted]
- **Smith CA**, Gunasti J, Murdock A, Collins O, Yeung H. Pseudofolliculitis barbae diagnosis and management in U.S. Veterans, Fiscal Years 2016-2022. Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Dermatology; March 27-31, 2026; Denver, CO. [ePoster accepted]
- **Smith CA**, Ohamadike O, Pulminskas A, Deitelzweig C, Abu-Ghosh F, Joshi K, Kitchens E, Gosnell E, Yeung H. Inter-rater Reliability of Remote Acne Severity Assessment of Home Photographs by Transmasculine Adults. Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Dermatology; March 28, 2026; Denver, CO. [Oral presentation and ePoster accepted]
- **Smith CA**, Wongvibulsin S, Lin AJ, Shen A, Rodriguez EDD, Holland VR. Refractory nasal pemphigus vegetans treated with dupilumab in a patient with multiple contraindications to first-line therapies. Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Dermatology; March 27, 2026; Denver, CO. [Oral presentation and ePoster accepted]
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Gunasti J, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Hidradenitis suppurativa incidence in transgender patients: a multi-center matched cohort study. Oral presentation at: 2025 Symposium on Hidradenitis Suppurativa Advances; November 2025; Nashville, TN.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Gunasti J, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Hidradenitis suppurativa incidence in transgender patients: a multi-center matched cohort study. Poster presented at: Symposium on Hidradenitis Suppurativa Advances; November 2025; Nashville, TN.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Murdock A, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Hidradenitis Suppurativa Prevalence in Transgender and Cisgender Youth: A Multi-Regional Cross-Sectional Study. Poster presented at: PeDRA Annual Conference; October 8, 2025; Minneapolis, MN.
- **Smith CA**, Yeung H, Cheng C, Hogeling M. Adherence to oral antibiotic duration guidelines for acne treatment in transgender adolescents: a retrospective cohort study. Poster presented at: PeDRA Annual Conference; October 8, 2025; Minneapolis, MN.

- **Smith CA**, Gunasti J, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Chen SC, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Baranowski MLH, Orenstein LAV, Yeung H. Hidradenitis suppurativa prevalence in transgender persons: a multi-regional cross-sectional study. Poster presented at: 2025 CalDerm-PDA Joint Meeting; August 22-24, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- Braun H, **Smith CA**, Demissie MT, Issa AM, Kidane TY, Stoff B, Yeung H. Curriculum on Research Self-Efficacy, Motivations, and Barriers for Dermatology Residents in Ethiopia. Oral presentation at: SID Annual Meeting; May 9, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- Braun H, **Smith CA**, Demissie MT, Issa AM, Kidane TY, Stoff B, Yeung H. Curriculum on Research Self-Efficacy, Motivations, and Barriers for Dermatology Residents in Ethiopia. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 9, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Chen, SC, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Acne incidence and severity in transgender adults: a multi-center cohort study. Oral presentation at: SID Annual Meeting; May 8, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Chen, SC, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Acne incidence and severity in transgender adults: a multi-center cohort study. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 5, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Acne incidence in transgender adolescents: a multi-center cohort study. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 5, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- Das R, **Smith CA**, Yeung, H. Permanent hair removal in gender diverse adults assigned male at birth: a cross-sectional study. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 5, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- Cheng AH, **Smith CA**, Yeung H. Smoking prevalence and cessation in skin cancer survivors: A cross-sectional survey. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 5, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- Pulminskas A, **Smith CA**, Joshi K, Rogers J, Deitelzweig C, Gosnell E, Kitchens E, Abu-Ghosh F, Machado K, Yeung H. Remote, participant-acquired images for acne research in transgender and gender-diverse individuals: A prospective cohort study. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 5, 2025; San Diego, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Li H, Yeung H. Guideline-concordant topical prescriptions for acne during oral antibiotics. Poster presented at: Health Services Research Day; May 4, 2025; Atlanta, GA.
- Cheng AH, **Smith CA**, Yeung H. Smoking prevalence and cessation in skin cancer survivors: A cross-sectional survey. Poster presented at: UGA-Winship Cancer Research Summit; April 21, 2025; Athens, GA.
- **Smith CA**, Kam L, Yeung H. Smoking cessation and persistence in skin cancer survivors: a cross-sectional study of National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey, 2009-2018. Poster presented at: Georgia Clinical & Translational Science Alliance Conference; March 7, 2025; Callaway Gardens, GA.
- **Smith CA**, Ohamadike C, Deitelzweig C, Nock MR, Cohen JM, Yeung H. Healthcare barriers among sexual and gender minority skin cancer survivors: A cross-sectional analysis. Poster presented at: Winship Annual Conference; November 11, 2024; Atlanta, GA.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Acne prevalence and severity in transgender adolescents: A multi-center, validated cohort study. Poster presented at: Pediatric Dermatology Research Alliance Annual Conference; November 10, 2024; Phoenix, AZ.
- **Smith CA**, Kaabi O, Joshi K, Tangpricha V, Goodman M, Yeung H. Understanding acne-related disparities in transgender youth: Barriers and opportunities for care. Oral presentation at: PeDRA NextGen 2024 Conference; November 9, 2024; Phoenix, AZ.
- **Smith CA**, Machado KTL, Cheng A, Tribble JT, Yeung H. Perceptions and satisfaction with treatment among sexual and gender minority skin cancer survivors: A national cancer survey. Oral presentation at: American Academy of Dermatology Expert Resource Group Meeting; September 17, 2024.
- **Smith CA**, Wang D, Pithadia D, Hogeling M, Cheng C. 311 Isotretinoin dosing and patient demographics predict elevation of triglyceride abnormalities during acne treatment. Poster presented at: SID Annual Meeting; May 16, 2024; Dallas, TX.
- **Smith CA**, Kuklinski LF. Association of eosinophilic diseases with skin cancer prevalence: a national cross-sectional study of adults using the Third National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey. Poster presented at: UCLA Health Jonsson Comprehensive Cancer Center Annual All Center Symposium; May 8, 2024; Los Angeles, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Wang D, Pithadia D, Hogeling M, Cheng C. Deconstructing Trends in the Equity of Teledermatology Use and Outcomes Among Acne Patients on Isotretinoin During the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Single-Center Retrospective

Comparative Analysis. Poster presented at: 2024 Annual Meeting of the American Academy of Dermatology; March 8, 2024; San Diego, CA.

- **Smith CA**, Ganz T, Nemeth E, Kuklinski L. Association of elevated transferrin saturation with lower prevalence of skin cancer diagnosis among adults: analysis of the third National Health and Nutritional Examination Survey. Poster presented at: 5th Annual San Diego Dermatology Symposium; February 2, 2024; San Diego, CA.
- Graham DS, Baker JL, Thompson CK, Holt AC, **Smith C**, Kapoor NS. Intraoperative Wire Localization for Breast Cancer Yields Low Margin Positivity Rates. Oral presentation at: 19th Annual Academic Surgical Congress; February 6, 2024; Washington, DC.
- Holt AC, Berkowitz M, McAndrew N, **Smith C**, Baker J, Kapoor N. Surgical outcomes after neoadjuvant chemotherapy with and without immunotherapy in patients with triple negative breast cancer. Poster presented at: 46th Annual San Antonio Breast Cancer Symposium; December 5, 2023; San Antonio, TX.
- **Smith CA**, Wang D, Pithadia D, Hogeling M, Cheng C. Comparative analysis of care provided by UCLA Dermatology for patients on Isotretinoin during the COVID-19 pandemic. Oral presentation at: UCLA Division of Dermatology 2022-2023 QI Project Presentation; June 27, 2023; Los Angeles, CA.
- **Smith CA**, Wang D, Pithadia D, Hogeling M, Cheng C. Comparative analysis of care provided by UCLA Dermatology for patients on Isotretinoin during the COVID-19 pandemic. Oral presentation at: UCLA Division of Dermatology Research Symposium; June 6, 2023; Los Angeles, CA.
- Cui X, Xu X, **Smith C**, Jin L-M, Zhang XP. Metalloalkyl Radical-mediated Reactions via Metalloradical Catalysis. Oral presentation at: 250th American Chemical Society National Meeting; August 16, 2015; Boston, MA.
- Cui X, Xu X, **Smith C**, Jin L-M, Zhang XP. Metalloalkyl Radical-mediated Reactions via Metalloradical Catalysis. Poster presented at: 250th American Chemical Society National Meeting; August 16, 2015; Boston, MA.
- Cui X, Xu X, **Smith C**, Jin L-M, Zhang XP. Metalloalkyl Radical-mediated Reactions via Metalloradical Catalysis. Poster presented at: American Chemical Society Florida Annual Meeting; May 12, 2015; Tampa, FL.
- **Smith C**, Cui X, Zhang XP. Co(II)-Metalloradical and Stable Organic Radical Cocatalyzed Radical Reactions. Poster presented at: 7th Annual Graduate Student and Post-Doctorate Research Symposium; March 10, 2015; Tampa, FL.
- **Smith C**, Calcul L, Baker B. Large Scale Isolation of diarylheptanoid Tau-reducing (+)-S-Myricanol from Myrica cerifera and derivatives generation.
    - Poster presented at: USF Oktoberfest; October 22, 2012; Tampa, FL.
    - Poster presented at: 10th Raymond N. Castle Student Research Conference; April 21, 2012; Tampa, FL.
- **Smith C**, Alexandrow M. Analysis of the correlation between the genetic expression and localization of pre-RC components in cancer tissues: Detection of a suitable biomarker for cancer treatment and diagnosis. Oral presentation at: Moffitt Leaders in New Knowledge Summer Research Presentation; August 2008; Tampa, FL.
- **Smith C**, Lloyd M. Analysis of RB1, E2F1 interaction in MCF-7 Breast Cancer Cells.
    - Oral presentation at: Hillsborough Secondary Science Professional Study Day; October 2007; Tampa, FL.
    - Oral presentation at: Moffitt Leaders in New Knowledge Summer Research Presentation; August 2007; Tampa, FL.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Fellow | Emory University, Department of Dermatology | June 2024 – May 2026

Mentor: Dr. Howa Yeung

- **PeDRA-funded multi-center acne study ($25,000):** Investigated acne epidemiology in transgender adolescents across four clinical sites.
- **Authored a study on sexual and gender minority skin cancer survivorship research**, analyzing treatment experiences, healthcare barriers, and survivorship resources among skin cancer survivors participating in the OUT National Cancer Survey (Archives of Dermatological Research, 2025).
- **Authored first-author reviews** on hormonal acne therapies (Dermatology and Therapy, 2025) and on common dermatologic needs in transgender and gender-diverse adolescents (Current Pediatrics Reports, 2025).

- **Engineered a rule-based Natural Language Processing pipeline** in Python to parse and categorize unstructured acne prescription text for over 10,000 doxycycline prescriptions. The tool was used to classify daily doses for analysis of real-world prescribing patterns and treatment pathways.
- **Developed an interactive REDCap-based acne severity rating system:** web application with multi-image zoom functionality, user-friendly keyboard shortcuts, and integrated training modules.
- **Architected the infrastructure for a remote reliability study**, featuring automated data capture from an interactive REDCap application and progress tracking for acne clinical research aimed to improve inclusion of transgender adults.
- **Automated a data pipeline** to rapidly generate medication lists specific to dermatologic conditions for the analysis of pseudofolliculitis barbae management patterns using VA Corporate Warehouse data, reducing analysis time by 10 hours per week.
- **Authored a study comparing psychosocial outcomes by history of gender-affirming hair removal in gender-diverse adults** assigned male at birth (Journal of the American Academy of Dermatology, 2025).

Medical Student | UCLA David Geffen School of Medicine | Jan 2022 – Present

Dermatologic Treatment and Outcomes (*Mentors: Dr. Carol Cheng, Dr. Marcia Hogeling*) | Jan 2022 – Present

- **Constructing a hybrid Machine Learning and Rule-Based Natural Language Processing pipeline** to extract detailed clinical data prescriptions and notes for the analysis of acne treatment pathways and prescribing patterns in transgender adolescents.
- **Led the design of a retrospective study on acne treatment** in transgender adolescents, authored the IRB protocol and secured institutional study approval.
- **Translated clinical research objectives on acne treatment** into a detailed data extraction protocol, guiding data scientists towards creation of a transgender adolescent cohort.
- **Developed the analytical plan** to assess oral antibiotic guideline adherence for acne treatment in transgender adolescents, provisioning a dataset to support future research initiatives.
- **Analyzed isotretinoin treatment retention** during the COVID-19 pandemic, utilizing propensity-score matching and multivariate regression to assess outcomes by demographics.

Skin Cancer Epidemiology (*Mentor: Dr. Lawrence Kuklinski*) | Jan 2023 – Jan 2025

- **Iron status and skin cancer association study** using NHANES data (20,000+ participants) (Clinical Cosmetic and Investigational Dermatology, 2025)
- **Skin cancer diagnosis associated with asthma and hay fever**: nationwide cross-sectional analysis (Archives of Dermatological Research, 2024)
- Designed and conducted study involving advanced statistical modeling including multiple imputation, marginal effects analysis, complex survey analysis

Surgical Oncology (*Mentor: Dr. Nimmi Kapoor*) | May 2023 – Oct 2024

- Breast cancer surgical outcomes and wire localization techniques (Two co-authored publications)
- Built comprehensive R database (200+ patients) and completed descriptive and inferential statistics

Graduate Research Experience | 2014 – 2018

Organic Chemistry

Graduate Research – The Scripps Research Institute (*Mentor: Dr. Phil Baran*) | Oct 2017 – Apr 2018

- **Synthetic methodology development:** Designed nickel-catalyzed cross-coupling reactions for sterically challenging quaternary carbon formation using novel organozinc reagents (*Angewandte Chemie International Edition*, 2018)
- Synthetic chemistry experience applicable to developing new therapies for dermatology

Graduate Research – University of South Florida (*Mentors: Dr. X. Michael Shi, X. Peter Zhang*) | Jun 2014 – Jul 2017

- **Catalyst synthesis and reaction development:** Synthesized and optimized gold-triazole catalysts for challenging C-C bond formations
- First-author publication and journal cover in *Chemical Communications* - designed novel gold-catalyzed vinyl ether hydroalkynylation pathway
- Method optimization: Developed reaction conditions and mechanistic understanding for previously unknown transformations

Early Research Experience | 2008 – 2014

Undergraduate Research – University of South Florida (*Mentor: Dr. Bill Baker*) | Oct 2011 – May 2014

- **Natural products drugs:** Extracted and structurally characterized bioactive compounds from *Myrica cerifera* for Alzheimer's disease therapeutics. Led large-scale compound isolation and purification workflows
- **Analytical chemistry:** Maintained and operated HPLC systems while training laboratory users on advanced instrumentation
- Third-author publication in *ACS Chemical Biology* on tau protein clearance mechanisms - contributing to neurodegenerative disease research

Gap Year Research – Moffitt Cancer Center (*Mentor: Dr. Mark Alexandrow*) | May 2008 – Aug 2009

- **Cancer cell cycle research**: Investigated pre-replication complex protein expression patterns in breast cancer cell lines in translational cancer research at a comprehensive cancer center
- **High-volume data**: Managed and analyzed data from 1,000+ tissue samples using protein biochemistry techniques
- **Biochemical techniques**: Performed protein extraction, western blot analysis, and immunofluorescence microscopy

VOLUNTEER

Venice Family Clinic – Dermatology Specialty Clinic	**Oct 2022 – present**
Founder of Glimmering Bridges – Grassroots Volunteer Organization	**Nov 2019 – present**
Council on Aging – Ombudsman Program	**Feb 2020 – Jun 2021**
Crisis Text Line – Crisis Counselor	**Jan 2020 – Jul 2021**
Red Cross – Blood Bank Ambassador and Screener	**Apr 2020 – Jul 2020**
School on Wheels Tutor	**Jan 2020 – Feb 2021**
SHARP Hospice Volunteer	**Sep 2018 – Dec 2018**
Tampa General Hospital Volunteer	**Oct 2012 – Feb 2014**
LGBTQ Haven Clinic	**Oct 2012 – Feb 2014**

WORK EXPERIENCE

Full-Time Research Fellow | Emory University, Department of Dermatology | Aug 2024 – July 2025

- **PeDRA-funded research leadership ($25,000):** Lead student conducting acne epidemiology study in transgender adolescents involving data from multiple Kaiser Permanente clinical sites
- Collaborated on multiple studies in LGBTQ+ dermatologic care, skin cancer survivorship disparities, and acne treatment patterns
- **Developed interactive REDCap survey with acne lesion counting module**, interactive user interface and integrated training using Javascript programming language.

Part-Time Analyst | APEX Strategies Group | Jan 2019 – Jan 2021

- Contributed to research reports and strategic decision-making for consulting clients
- Maintained client information systems and supported business development activities

Full-Time Pediatric Medical Scribe | Neighborhood Healthcare | Jul 2018 – Dec 2018

- Maintained accurate patient records in electronic medical systems during pediatric encounters
- Supported clinician efficiency through real-time documentation and chart management

Full-Time Graduate Teaching Assistant | University of South Florida | Aug 2014 – Jul 2015

- Instructed General Chemistry II, Organic Chemistry I, and Analytical Chemistry lab courses for 100+ undergraduate students each semester
- Provided individualized support for lab students and graded assessments for undergraduate chemistry courses

Part-Time Cashier | The Fresh Market | Jul 2010 – Apr 2011

- Operated registers to process customer transactions
- Organized receipts, maintained clean work areas, and assisted other departments with food preparation and cleaning tasks

Part-Time Academic Tutor | Mount Greylock Regional School | Sep 2009 – Apr 2010

- Provided mathematics and science tutoring for K-12 students
- Developed individualized learning strategies and test preparation materials

AWARDS

Sep 2025: PeDRA NextGen 2025 Travel Award

Sep 2025: SHSA 2025 Travel Award - Oral presentation

Nov 2024: PeDRA NextGen 2024 Travel Award - Oral presentation

Jul 2024: 2024 Pediatric Dermatology Research Alliance Research Fellowship, Acne incidence and treatment in transgender adolescents: a multi-center, validated cohort study, $25,000

Mar 2021: David Geffen Medical Student Scholarship - Highest Award to Incoming UCLA Medical Students

May 2017: Milligan Graduate Fellowship (declined)

Apr 2016: NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention

Aug 2015: Florida Georgia Louis Stokes Alliance Graduate Fellowship (2 years)

May 2014: George Wenzinger Memorial Scholarship in Organic Chemistry

May 2013: Clear Springs Land Undergraduate Poster - 1st Place Natural Products

May 2008: Moffitt Team Award for Excellence In Research and Research Support

Feb 2008: NAACP Research Competition - Silver Medal for Medicine, Health

May 2008: Intel ISEF Albany College of Pharmacy Special Award

Jan 2008: Regional Science Fair – Best in Fair, 1st Place Medicine, Health, Dr. Riggs Memorial